

SEED

1. Passage anchor

> “In a way, she planted a **seed**.”

Passage meaning

****seed**** = the beginning of an idea, feeling, change, or future development

****種子；開端；萌芽****

Here, ****seed**** is metaphorical.

Mrs. Chan’s words acted like a small beginning that later grew into:

* greater confidence

* a different mindset

* less obsession with perfection

* more willingness to communicate

So:

****plant a seed****

= ****種下一個想法 / 為日後的改變埋下種子****

Practice

1. Her encouragement planted a ****seed of confidence**** in me.

她的鼓勵在我心中種下了****自信的種子****。

2. That conversation was the ****seed of an idea**** that later became a real project.

那次談話是後來發展成真正專案的****想法萌芽****。

Core meanings of SEED

2. seed — a small part of a plant from which a new plant can grow

= the reproductive part of a plant that can develop into a new plant

****種子****

This is the central literal meaning.

Examples

1. She planted several flower **seeds**.

她種下了幾顆花的**種子**。

2. These **seeds** need warm soil to grow.

這些**種子**需要溫暖的土壤才能生長。

3. seed — the small hard part inside some fruits

= a small reproductive structure found inside fruit

籽；**種子**

Examples

1. Remove the **seeds** from the watermelon.

把西瓜裡的**籽**去掉。

2. The grapes contain several small **seeds**.

這些葡萄裡有幾顆小**籽**。

Note

Depending on the fruit, Chinese may naturally use:

* 籽

* 種子

* 核

But English **seed** is not always the same as **stone / pit**.

Figurative beginnings

4. seed — the beginning of an idea or development

= something small that may later grow into something larger

萌芽；**開端**；**種子**

This is the passage family.

Examples

1. The discussion contained the **seed** of a solution.

那場討論中已經有了解決方案的**萌芽**。

2. That experience was the ****seed of his interest in science****.
那次經歷是他對科學產生興趣的****開端****。

5. seed of an idea

= the earliest form of an idea before it is fully developed
****想法的萌芽；初步構想****

Examples

1. She already had the ****seed of an idea**** for a new book.
她已經有了一個新書構想的****萌芽****。
2. The meeting gave me the ****seed of an idea****.
那場會議讓我有了一個****初步想法****。

6. seeds of change

= early conditions or ideas that later produce change
****改變的種子；變革的萌芽****

Examples

1. The experience planted the ****seeds of change****.
那次經歷播下了****改變的種子****。
2. Small reforms can contain the ****seeds of larger change****.
小型改革可能包含更大變革的****萌芽****。

7. seeds of doubt

= small doubts that begin to grow
****懷疑的種子；疑念****

Examples

1. His inconsistent answers planted the ****seeds of doubt****.
他前後不一致的回答種下了****懷疑的種子****。

2. The report created ****seeds of doubt**** in her mind.

那份報告在她心中產生了****疑念****。

8. seeds of conflict / trouble

= early causes that may later develop into conflict or problems

****衝突 / 麻煩的根源或萌芽****

Examples

1. The decision planted the ****seeds of future conflict****.

那項決定埋下了未來****衝突的種子****。

2. Poor communication can sow the ****seeds of trouble****.

溝通不良可能埋下****麻煩的種子****。

Verb: produce or scatter seed

9. seed — produce seeds

= form or release seeds

****結籽；產生種子****

Examples

1. Let the flowers ****seed**** naturally.

讓這些花自然****結籽****。

2. Some grasses ****seed**** very quickly.

有些草類很快就會****結籽****。

This is less common in everyday learner English but established.

10. seed an area

= sow seed over an area of land

****播種；撒種****

Examples

1. They ****seeded the field**** with grass.

他們在田裡****播下草籽****。

2. The bare ground was ****seeded**** in spring.

那塊裸地在春天被****播種****。

Remove seeds

11. seed a fruit

= remove the seeds from fruit

****去籽****

Examples

1. ****Seed the peppers**** before chopping them.

切辣椒前先****去籽****。

2. She ****seeded the tomatoes**** before making the sauce.

她做醬汁前先把番茄****去籽****。

Important

As a verb, ****seed**** can therefore mean either:

* add/sow seed

* remove seeds

Context decides.

Sports and competition

12. seed — noun: a ranked competitor

= a player or team given a ranking in advance of a tournament

****種子選手；種子隊****

Examples

1. She entered the tournament as the top ****seed****.

她以頭號****種子選手****身分參賽。

2. The number-one **seed** won the match.

第一**種子選手**贏得了比賽。

This is a major distinct modern sense.

13. seeded — ranked in a tournament

= officially placed in a ranked position before competition

****列為種子的；有種子排名的****

Examples

1. He was **seeded second** in the tournament.

他在賽事中被列為**第二種子**。

2. The team is highly **seeded** this year.

這支隊伍今年的**種子排名很高**。

14. seed a player / team

= assign a ranking to a competitor before a tournament

****把.....列為種子選手 / 隊伍****

Examples

1. She was **seeded first**.

她被列為**第一種子**。

2. The organizers **seeded the strongest teams** separately.

主辦方把最強的隊伍分別列為**種子隊**。

Computing / technical use

15. seed — initial value used to generate a sequence

= a starting value used by an algorithm, especially a random-number generator

****種子值；初始值****

Examples

1. The program uses a random **seed**.
這個程式使用一個隨機**種子值**。
2. Using the same **seed** can reproduce the same sequence.
使用相同的**種子值**可以重現相同序列。

This is a common computing sense.

16. seed data

= initial data inserted into a database or system
初始資料；種子資料

Examples

1. The application includes **seed data** for testing.
這個應用程式包含測試用的**初始資料**。
2. Developers loaded **seed data** into the database.
開發人員把**種子資料**載入資料庫。

Technical but useful.

17. seed a database / system

= populate a system with initial data
把初始資料匯入；預先填入資料

Examples

1. The script **seeds the database** with sample users.
這個腳本會把範例使用者**預先寫入資料庫**。
2. We **seeded the system** with test records.
我們把測試紀錄**預先加入系統**。

Investment and business

18. seed money / seed funding

= initial money provided to help a new business or project begin

****種子資金；初期資金****

Examples

1. The startup received ****seed funding**** from several investors.

那家新創公司從幾位投資者獲得了****種子資金****。

2. They used the ****seed money**** to build the first prototype.

他們用****初期資金****製作第一個原型。

The metaphor is:

small beginning → later growth.

19. seed investor

= an investor who provides very early-stage funding

****種子投資人；早期投資者****

Examples

1. The company is looking for a ****seed investor****.

公司正在尋找****種子投資人****。

2. A ****seed investor**** helped finance the first version of the product.

一名****早期投資者****資助了產品的第一個版本。

Biology and reproduction

20. seed — reproductive material

In biological or agricultural contexts, ****seed**** can refer broadly to reproductive material used for propagation.

****種子；繁殖材料****

Examples

1. Farmers carefully select high-quality ****seed****.

農民會仔細挑選高品質的****種子****。

2. The crop is grown from certified ****seed****.

這種作物是用經認證的****種子****栽培的。

Here, **seed** can be uncountable when referring to seed as agricultural material.

Food

21. seeds as food

= edible seeds used as ingredients or snacks

籽；種子類食物

Examples:

* sunflower seeds 葵花籽

* pumpkin seeds 南瓜籽

* sesame seeds 芝麻

* chia seeds 奇亞籽

Practice

1. Sprinkle some sesame **seeds** on top.

在上面撒一些芝麻**籽**。

2. Pumpkin **seeds** are often eaten as a snack.

南瓜**籽**常被當作零食食用。

Word-family extensions

22. seeding

= the act or process of sowing, introducing, or assigning seeds/rankings/data

播種；設定種子；植入初始資料

Examples

1. Spring **seeding** begins next week.

春季**播種**下週開始。

2. Tournament **seeding** is based on ranking points.

賽事的**種子排序**是依排名積分決定的。

3. Database **seeding** is part of the setup process.

資料庫**初始資料建立**是設定流程的一部分。

The meaning depends heavily on domain.

23. seedling

= a very young plant grown from a seed

****幼苗****

Examples

1. The ****seedlings**** need regular watering.
這些****幼苗****需要定期澆水。
2. We moved the ****seedlings**** into larger pots.
我們把****幼苗****移到較大的花盆裡。

Very useful family extension.

24. seedless

= containing no seeds

****無籽的****

Examples

1. These are ****seedless grapes****.
這些是****無籽葡萄****。
2. I prefer ****seedless watermelon****.
我比較喜歡****無籽西瓜****。

25. seeded

Outside sports, ****seeded**** can also mean:

A. containing seeds

****有籽的****

B. having had the seeds removed

in some culinary contexts, **去籽的**

Because these can conflict, context is essential.

Examples:

* seeded bread = 含種子的麵包

* seeded tomatoes = 去籽番茄 in some recipe contexts

High-value expressions

26. plant a seed

= introduce an idea or possibility that can develop later

種下一顆種子；播下想法的種子

Examples

1. The teacher **planted a seed** that later became a career ambition.

老師**種下了一顆種子**，後來發展成職業理想。

2. Her question **planted a seed in my mind**.

她的問題在我心中**種下了一個念頭**。

Exact passage expression.

27. sow the seeds of something

= create the beginnings of a future development

播下.....的種子；埋下.....的伏筆

Examples

1. The experience **sowed the seeds of change**.

那次經歷**播下了改變的種子**。

2. Their disagreement **sowed the seeds of future conflict**.

他們的分歧**埋下了日後衝突的種子**。

Often used for both positive and negative developments.

28. seed of doubt

= a small doubt that may grow stronger

疑念；懷疑的種子

Examples

1. His reaction planted a **seed of doubt** in my mind.
他的反應在我心中種下了一絲**疑念**。
2. Once the **seed of doubt** was there, she started questioning everything.
一旦有了那顆**懷疑的種子**，她便開始質疑一切。

29. go to seed

= become neglected, untidy, or less healthy/attractive than before

衰敗；荒廢；變得邋遢

Examples

1. The garden has **gone to seed**.
那座花園已經**荒廢了**。
2. The old building was slowly **going to seed**.
那棟老建築正逐漸**破敗**。

This comes from plants being allowed to mature and seed rather than being maintained.

Countability

30. seed — countable

When referring to individual seeds:

- * a seed
- * two seeds
- * several seeds

Example

She planted three ****seeds****.
她種了三顆****種子****。

31. seed — uncountable

In farming, ****seed**** can mean seed material generally.

Example

Farmers need high-quality ****seed****.
農民需要高品質的****種子材料****。

Compare:

- * ****a seed**** = one individual seed
- * ****seed**** = seed as agricultural material

Key contrasts

32. seed vs plant

****seed****
= the reproductive structure from which a plant can grow
****種子****

****plant****
= the living organism itself
****植物****

Compare:

- > We planted a ****seed****.
- > 我們種下一顆****種子****。

- > The ****plant**** grew quickly.
- > 那株****植物****長得很快。

33. seed vs grain

****seed****

= reproductive structure capable of producing a new plant

****種子****

****grain****

= small hard seed of cereal crops such as wheat, rice, or corn, especially as food

****穀粒 ; 穀物****

Compare:

* sunflower seed

* wheat grain

A grain is biologically often a type of seed, but the everyday vocabulary differs.

34. seed vs pit / stone

****seed****

= typically a smaller reproductive unit

****pit / stone****

= large hard central structure inside some fruits

****果核****

Examples:

* apple seeds

* grape seeds

* peach pit / peach stone

* cherry pit / stone

So *peach seed* is not the normal everyday term for the whole hard center.

35. seed vs kernel

****kernel****

= the edible inner part of a seed, nut, or grain, depending on context

****仁 ; 穀粒****

Examples:

* corn kernel 玉米粒

* kernel of a nut 果仁

****seed**** is the broader reproductive term.

36. seed vs beginning

****beginning****

= neutral start of something

****開始****

****seed****

= a small beginning that contains the potential to grow into something larger

****萌芽；種子****

Compare:

> That was the ****beginning**** of the project.

> 那是專案的****開始****。

> That conversation was the ****seed**** of the project.

> 那次談話是這個專案的****萌芽****。

The second strongly suggests later development.

Meaning map

The central literal concept is:

****a small biological structure containing the potential for future growth****

From this develop several metaphorical branches:

Plant reproduction

seed

→ ****種子****

Beginning of development

seed of an idea

→ ****萌芽；開端****

Early cause

seeds of conflict / doubt

→ **根源；種子**

Sports ranking

top seed

→ **種子選手**

Computing

random seed

→ **初始種子值**

Business

seed funding

→ **種子資金**

Across these figurative uses, the same metaphor remains:

****a small starting element that determines or enables later development.****

Passage recap

> “In a way, she planted a ****seed****.”

Here:

****seed** = **a small beginning of an idea or personal change that could grow over time****

Best Traditional Chinese renderings:

* **種子**

* **想法的萌芽**

* **改變的開端**

Natural contextual meaning:

****她在我心中種下了一顆日後會慢慢成長的種子。****

MCQ-ready meaning

****seed** in the passage**

= ****the beginning of an idea, feeling, or future development****

****萌芽；開端；種子****

The literal plant meaning is being used metaphorically:

****seed → grows later****

****idea/influence → develops later****